

# Ecuador

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Ecuador exports more bananas than any other country — and is the leading exporter of the bananas that are sold in North American supermarkets. If you ate a banana today, chances are that it grew in Ecuador. This is because bananas from Ecuador are cheap. Ecuadorean bananas are cheap because the cost of producing them is low.

One reason costs are low is that Ecuadorean banana workers are the lowest-paid in Latin America. In 2002, male banana-plantation workers earned about \$6.40 Cdn a day. Women were paid even less, and children were sometimes not paid at all. There was no overtime pay, and few workers received benefits, such as paid vacations and sick leave.



# Banana Split

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| Group            | Your Choice | Actual |
|------------------|-------------|--------|
| Banana Pickers   |             |        |
| Land Owners      |             |        |
| Shipping Company |             |        |
| Importer         |             |        |
| Wholesaler       |             |        |
| Processor        |             |        |
| Distributor      |             |        |
| Retail           |             |        |